

Episode 1 — The Listener · Actor Sides

VO LOCK v1.0 · locked 11 July 2026 · these lines are final — report any stumble to production; do not improvise fixes

Context for both actors: Echoes of Havenbay is a true-crime podcast. Grounded, intimate, noir-lite — never campy, never announcer-voiced. The microphone is close. Ally speaks to one listener at a time. Dot is a 72-year-old widow leaving voicemails to a show she loves: warm, dry-witted, unhurried, never feeble.

ALLY QUINN — 14 CUES

E1-03 · The opening

polished host voice, fatigue underneath

My show ends the same way every week: I read out the tip-line number and say, tell me what this city won't. The line keeps voices, timestamps and nothing else. That's the promise. Dot has left the last message after every episode for three years.

E1-04

remorse under restraint — the guilt is real, the control is professional

Three nights ago — 3:04 on Friday morning — she left the message you just heard a piece of. Forty seconds. No words. She opened the line and let the house speak for her. It waited three days in my queue. I was busy making a show about listening.

E1-05

resolve; returning to host register

Dot, if you can hear this: goodnight, the harbour misses you. Everyone else — this is Echoes of Havenbay. The tip line is open. This week, it's mine to answer.

E1-06 · The case alert

host register, steadier than she feels

This is Echoes of Havenbay, with a case alert. Her name is Dot Ellis, from Rivermouth. At 3:04 on Friday morning, someone was inside her house. She hasn't been heard from since.

E1-07

level, factual

Police logged a welfare check. No forced entry, no report from family, and an adult is allowed to leave home without explaining herself. They won't call it an abduction. I'm not asking them to — yet.

E1-08

direct appeal

So we do what this show does. We knock on Rivermouth's doors ourselves — and you'll notice I'm not saying her street on this feed. If you knew Dot Ellis, the tip line is open, and it keeps no names.

E1-09

quiet steel; speaking to one particular listener

One more thing, for whoever needs to hear it. She left us your footsteps. Eight of them — eight steps too slow to stay invisible. That was Friday. We're faster now.

E1-10 · The closing episode

host register, warmer than the opening

This is Echoes of Havenbay. Dot Ellis is safe. She was found through the life she left in plain sight — a school, a parish, a bus route, and three years of messages nobody had thought to treat as evidence. She declined an interview. Her words: "I'm not content, love. I'm a person."

E1-11 · Branch A — record both variants

owning the cost of the loud road

On the record: the van traces to Harbourline Security — dissolved in 2011, still driving. You heard the full track when we did, and it worked, and it cost: two hundred ghosts in the queue, and the van gone before police reached it. Loud truth. I'd choose it again. I think.

E1-12 · Branch B — record both variants

owning the cost of the quiet road

On the record: the van traces to a dissolved port-security company. Del has asked me to keep its name off this feed — and this time, I'm listening. Quiet truth cost an afternoon of silence I don't want to spend again. I'd choose it again. I think.

E1-13

plain; a rule being made, not a speech

And one thing changes at this show, starting tonight: a voice can tell us where to look without me telling everyone else where it lives. That's the new rule. Dot wrote it; I'm just reading it out.

E1-14

intimate and controlled — not a costume change

And now — not as a reporter, but to the man with the careful walk: this show is built on listening. This case taught me who else does. She's safe. The evidence is safe. You're the only one still hiding.

E1-16 · The last line

four words, then the promise. Let the pause before the promise do the work

Goodnight, Dot. Goodnight, harbour. — The tip line stays open.

DOT ELLIS — 7 CUES (ONE SESSION)

E1-01 · The voicemail that opens the game

warm, amused, unhurried — a woman who enjoys leaving this message

It's Dot from Rivermouth, love. Nothing worth troubling you with — the gulls held a parliament on my roof, and the quiet boats went by twice. Say goodnight to the harbour for me, Ally.

E1-15 · The voicemail that ends the episode

warm; the ritual, reclaimed — she's teasing and she means every word

It's Dot. Not from Rivermouth tonight — imagine that. Vera says hello, which for Vera is a parade. You found an old woman who didn't want a fuss and you made one anyway. Good girl. Say goodnight to the harbour for me, Ally.

ARC-1 · Archive clip

everyday; mid-thought

The gulls again, love. A full parliament, right on my roof.

ARC-2 · Archive clip

fond

School let out early — bell went at noon and the little ones sang all the way down the road.

ARC-3 · Archive clip

observational, matter-of-fact

Bridge sang twice tonight. Boats running late.

ARC-4 · Archive clip

mock-offended; a joke she's made before

The quiet boats went by again. No lights. Rude, I call it.

ARC-5 · Archive clip

warm; her sign-off with a flourish

Say goodnight to the harbour for me. And the lighthouse, while you're at it. It gets left out.

In-game dialogue note: Dot also has six unvoiced in-game scenes (the hill cottage reunion). If her voice casting succeeds beyond expectations, those lines are pickup candidates for a v1.x "fully voiced" pass — do not record them in this session.